

FortiSASE Architect

Certification

This exam is part of the following certification track:



Visit the [Cybersecurity Certification](#) page for information about certification requirements.

Exams available at [Pearson VUE](#) are listed below. Select an exam to view the details.

— Fortinet NSE 7 - SASE 26 Architect

Status: ● Available

The Fortinet NSE 7 - *FortiSASE 26 Architect* exam evaluates your knowledge of designing, deploying, and operating advanced Fortinet FortiSASE and SD-WAN solutions.

This exam evaluates your advanced knowledge of FortiSASE and Fortinet SD-WAN configuration and operation, including real-world deployment scenarios, integration of secure access services with SD-WAN, support for distributed users and edge locations, and troubleshooting complex SD-WAN and FortiSASE deployments.

Once you pass the exam, you will receive the following exam badge:



Audience

The Fortinet NSE 7 - *FortiSASE 26 Architect* exam is intended for network and security professionals responsible for designing, deploying, administering, monitoring, and troubleshooting Fortinet FortiSASE and SD-WAN solutions, including complex deployment scenarios, troubleshooting advanced environments, and analyzing operational and security data across distributed users and edge locations.

Exam Details

Exam name	Fortinet NSE 7 - <i>FortiSASE 26 Architect</i>
Time allowed	70–80 minutes
Exam questions	40–50 questions
Scoring	Pass or fail. A score report is available from your Pearson VUE account.

[Help](#)

Language	English
Product version	FortiSASE 26, FortiOS 7.4 and 7.6

Exam Topics

Successful candidates have applied knowledge and skills in the following areas and tasks:

▼ SD-WAN architecture and deployment (10–20% of the exam)

Tasks	Details
Design enterprise SD-WAN architectures	• Architecture components • Use case identification • Zero-touch provisioning (ZTP) of SD-WAN branches • Device deployment with ZTP • Device blueprints and device imports using CSV files • Steps for ZTP of SD-WAN branches • Multiregion topologies and large deployments • Use cases—SD-WAN multiregion topologies • Multiregion topology routing • Common managed security service provider (MSSP) deployments with SD-WAN • Virtual routing and forwarding (VRF)-aware overlays
Deploy SD-WAN infrastructure	• Direct internet access (DIA) topologies • DIA best practices and recommended settings • Basic SD-WAN DIA setup • SD-WAN traffic distribution and member health • SD-WAN traffic logs and events • SD-WAN member and zone configuration • Underlay and overlay links • Dual-hub topologies • Use cases for SD-WAN with dual-hub topologies • Dual-hub options in the SD-WAN overlay template • Configuration specifics for large topologies
Implement SD-WAN performance controls	• SLA targets • Active and passive monitoring • SLA configuration • SLA monitoring • Member status and performance • Advanced settings • Member state change actions • ICMP probe passing of SLA information • Advanced performance SLA settings • SD-WAN monitoring tools that FortiManager provides • SD-WAN logs on FortiAnalyzer • SD-WAN analytics and reports available on FortiAnalyzer

▼ SD-WAN traffic control and IPsec (20–30% of the exam)

Tasks	Details
Design SD-WAN rules	• User-defined SD-WAN rules • SD-WAN rule lookup process • SD-WAN for local-out traffic • Implicit SD-WAN rule • SD-WAN rule strategies • SD-WAN rule traffic matching criteria • Application steering and application learning phases • Internet services as destination criteria • Preferred member election based on strategy • Advantage given to higher priority members • SD-WAN rule status monitoring • Use cases—rule configuration and monitoring
Configure SD-WAN routing	• Key routing principles in SD-WAN • Policy routes • Route lookup process • Member static routes • Static routes for zones • Member probe routes • Session tables • Different protocol states • Common session flags • Session reevaluation and triggers • Routing changes in SNAT sessions • BGP routing and self-healing • BGP advanced option for SD-WAN • Routing options for dual-hub topologies
Deploy advanced IPsec for SD-WAN	• SD-WAN overlay design • SD-WAN overlay configuration with BGP • Scalable SD-WAN hub-and-spoke topology • IPsec and SD-WAN required settings • IPsec and BGP for BGP per overlay deployments • IPsec and BGP for BGP on loopback deployments • BGP configuration to exchange additional paths • Overlay stickiness • Use cases—SD-WAN overlay-as-a-service • Auto-discovery VPN (ADVPN)

▼ FortiSASE architecture and integration (15–25% of the exam)

Tasks	Details
Evaluate FortiSASE components in advanced deployment scenarios	• FortiSASE provisioning • MSSP workflow • FortiSASE licence types • FortiFlex offering • Secure internet access (SIA) use cases • SIA for FortiClient agent-based remote users • SIA for agentless remote users • SIA for edge devices • FortiExtender/FortiBranch SASE • FortiAP as an edge device • Branch on-ramp • Private proxy • Secure Private Access (SPA) use cases—SD-WAN, next-generation firewall (NGFW), secure SaaS access (SSA) • Fortinet SASE solution • Dedicated public IP address functionality • RESTful API support • SASE infrastructure and points of presence (POP) • Data residency • Data sovereignty
Integrate FortiSASE into hybrid networks	• Advanced deployment implementations for branch and remote users • SIA for edge devices • FortiExtender/FortiBranch SASE • FortiAP as an edge device • SD-WAN on-ramp • FortiSASE as a spoke • SIA deployment for remote users • Use cases—log forwarding to FortiAnalyzer through SPA, performing traffic analytics
Integrate SD-WAN and FortiSASE workflows	• FortiSASE architecture • Site-based remote users using FortiGate SD-WAN as a secure edge • Site-based remote users using SD-WAN on-ramp • SPA using SD-WAN • SPA with SD-WAN deployment using FortiSASE • SD-WAN review • SPA with SD-WAN deployment use cases (single hub, dual hub) • FortiSASE as a spoke

▼ FortiSASE deployment and secure access (20–30% of the exam)

Tasks	Details
Deploy FortiSASE access and onboarding	• SIA for FortiClient agent-based remote users • SIA for agentless remote users • SIA for edge devices • Secure SPA deployments • SPA use cases—SD-WAN, NGFW, SSA • FortiSASE SAML authentication for administrators • User authentication source • FortiClient installers • FortiSASE dashboards and GUI tool management

Tasks	Details
Configure endpoint posture and access control	• Endpoint profiles • Security posture tags • Endpoint upgrade • Endpoint management • FortiClient agent • Digital experience monitoring (DEM) workflow • Advanced endpoint profile settings • On-net and off-net use cases • Network lockdown • Steering bypass destinations • FortiSASE security posture tagging rules for endpoint compliance • Basic HTTPS access proxy with SSL certificate-based authentication • FortiSASE security posture tags
Deploy cloud-delivered secure services	• SPA FortiGate configuration • FortiSASE to the Fortinet Security Fabric • SaaS and SPA application monitoring • SPA use cases—NGFW • Security policy enforcement • Agentless ZTNA • Service availability and POP monitoring

▼ Centralized management, visibility and troubleshooting (10–20% of the exam)

Tasks	Details
Centrally manage FortiSASE and SD-WAN deployments	• FortiManager features for SD-WAN • SD-WAN management on FortiManager • FortiManager integration and configuration with FortiSASE • Use cases—log forwarding to FortiAnalyzer through SPA, performing traffic analytics • SOC-as-a-Service (SOCaaS) • FortiGuard forensic analysis
Analyze traffic and security logs	• FortiClient diagnostic logs • SD-WAN log identification • Analytics and reports
Troubleshoot connectivity and policy behavior	• General troubleshooting commands useful in an SD-WAN context • CLI commands to observe SD-WAN parameters and behavior • Tunnel connectivity issues • Tunnel performance issues • SPA connectivity issues • FortiClient diagnostic logs • Packet captures for connected endpoints • Use cases—packet capture on FortiSASE, FortiClient diagnostic tools

Training Resources

The following resources are recommended for attaining the knowledge and skills that are covered on the exam. The recommended training is available as a foundation for exam preparation. In addition to training, you are strongly encouraged to have hands-on experience with the exam topics and objectives.

- [*FortiSASE Enterprise Administrator*](#) course and hands-on labs
- [*SD-WAN Enterprise Administrator*](#) course and hands-on labs
- [*FortiSASE Core Administrator*](#) course and hands-on labs
- [*SD-WAN Core Administrator*](#) course and hands-on labs
- *FortiSASE—Administration Guide*
- *FortiSASE—Reference Guide*

- *FortiSASE—Architecture Guide*
 - *FortiSASE—Deployment Guide*
 - *SD-WAN—Deployment Guide*
 - *FortiOS—Administration Guide*
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Experience

- 3 years of experience with networking
- 3 years of experience with network security
- 2 years of experience with FortiGate and FortiManager
- 1 year of experience with FortiSASE

Exam Sample Questions

A set of sample questions is available from the Fortinet Training Institute. These questions represent the exam content in question type and content scope. However, the questions do not necessarily represent all the exam content, nor are they intended to assess your readiness to take the certification exam.

See the [Fortinet Training Institute](#) for the course that includes the sample questions

Examination Policies and Procedures

The Fortinet Training Institute recommends that you review the exam policies and procedures before you register for the exam. Access important information on the [Fortinet Training Institute Policies](#) page, and find answers to common questions on the [FAQ](#) page.

Questions?

If you have more questions about the NSE Certification Program, contact us through the [Fortinet Training Institute Helpdesk](#) page.